

tem folders under this scenario (the Program Files folder is considered a system folder). The easiest solution to this problem is to install the game in the user's personal folder, for which the user has all the required permissions. If you are still stuck with an errant game, consider changing the permission settings for that particular game's folder (See box *Granting Permissions*)

Opening Firewalls

By default, most programs are blocked by Windows Firewall. To work properly, some programs might require you to allow them to communicate through the firewall. To do so, follow these steps:

1. Open Windows Firewall by typing "fire" in the search panel of the Start Menu
 2. In the left pane, click "Allow a program through Windows Firewall"
 3. Select the checkbox next to the program you want to allow, and then click OK
3. Copy-protection issues. Some games use copy-protection techniques to prevent piracy. Some of these schemes might not work under UAC, since the schemes presume full admin-access at all times. For example, games using the StarForce copy-protection face problems under Vista. StarForce does not work properly in Vista environments. However, StarForce has recently released a new version of its software that is certified to be compatible with Vista.
 4. Breaking one's head against the firewall. Some games require access to the Internet to function properly (multiplayer titles, or MMORPG games, for example). However, Windows has relatively recently added a firewall feature (with Windows XP SP2) and some games are simply not aware of such a security checkpoint. These therefore fail to log themselves in as exceptions to the firewall and are promptly blocked by Windows (XP or Vista). The solution? Add the game to the exception list of the firewall yourself (See box *Opening Firewalls*)